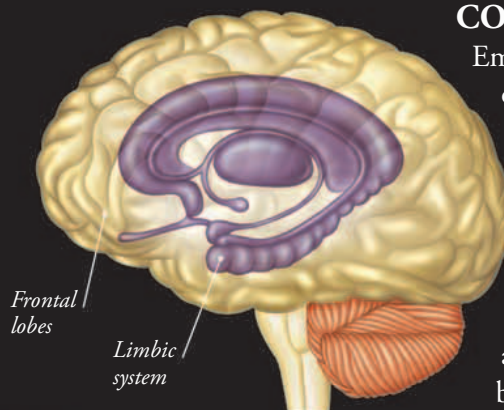


The feeling mind

In addition to creating thoughts and memories, the brain conjures up powerful feelings called emotions. Our most basic emotions, such as fear, anger, and disgust, are survival instincts that protect us from danger. Emotions don't just affect the mind—they affect the whole body, causing physical reactions as well as mental ones.

EMOTIONS

Our emotions are produced by parts of the brain that we don't voluntarily control. They seem to well up from nowhere, and they are difficult to hide since we show them with our faces and our body language. But they can also be enjoyable—the best movies are those that succeed in triggering genuine feelings of fear, surprise, sadness, and joy.



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Emotions are generated in a part of the brain called the limbic system. This structure is found in animal brains too, which is why some scientists call it primitive. Unlike animals, we can resist the urge to act on strong emotions because more advanced parts of the human brain—the frontal lobes—act like policemen, enabling us to think before we act.

